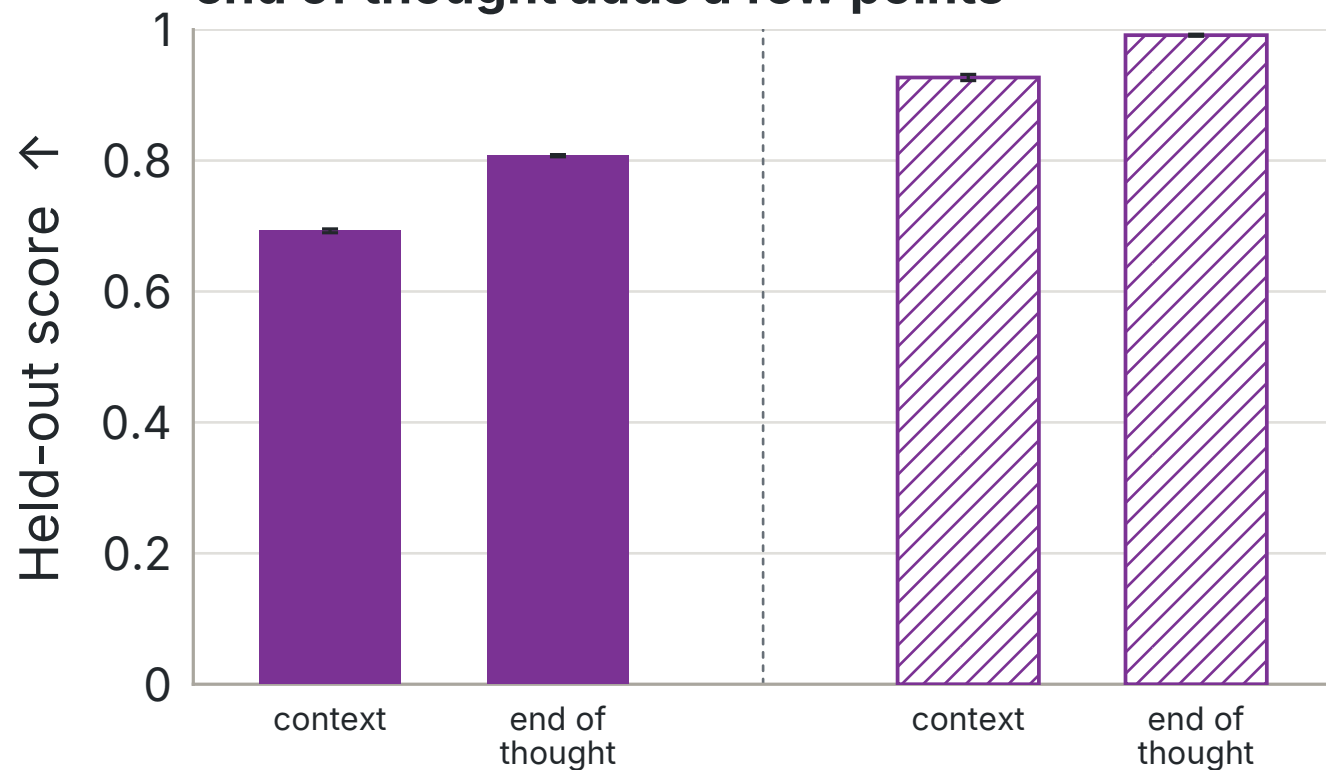


## CORPORA

Needs-reasoning corpora only

A · OPENTHINKER3-7B, LAYER 19

**Context state already retrieves the answer;  
end of thought adds a few points**

Held-out  $R^2$ 

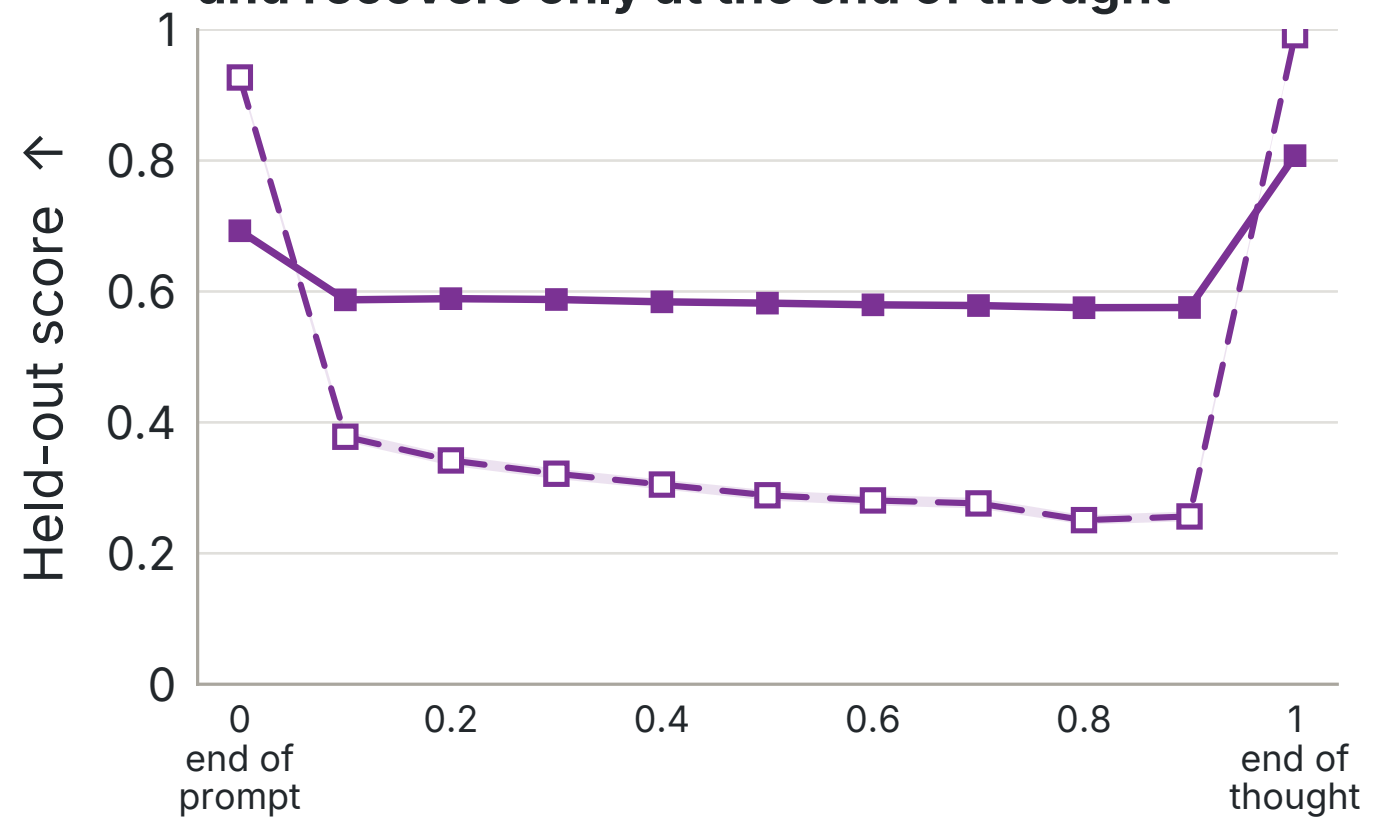
Answer retrieval (acc@1)

## METRIC

Held-out  $R^2$  Answer retrieval (acc@1)

B · OPENTHINKER3-7B, LAYER 19

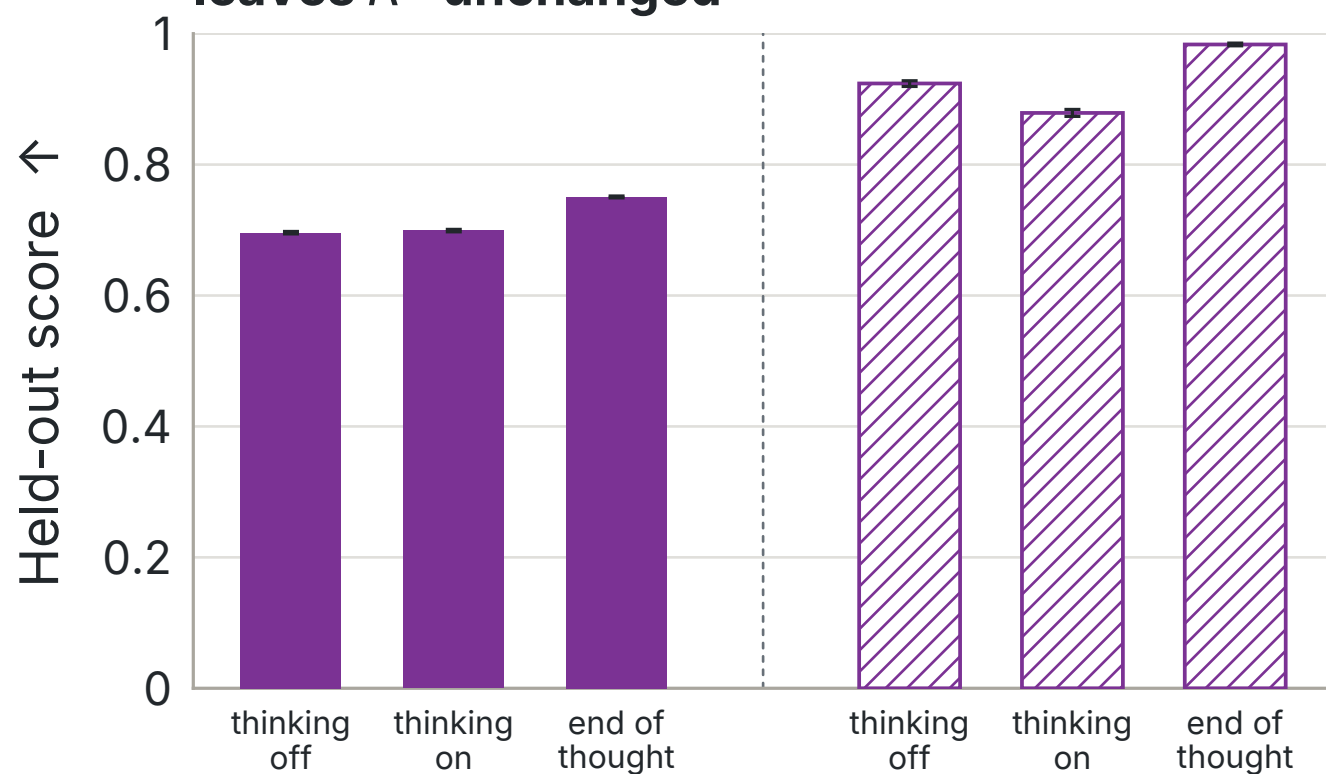
**Predictability dips inside the reasoning trace  
and recovers only at the end of thought**



Position in the thinking span

C · QWEN3-8B, LAYER 24

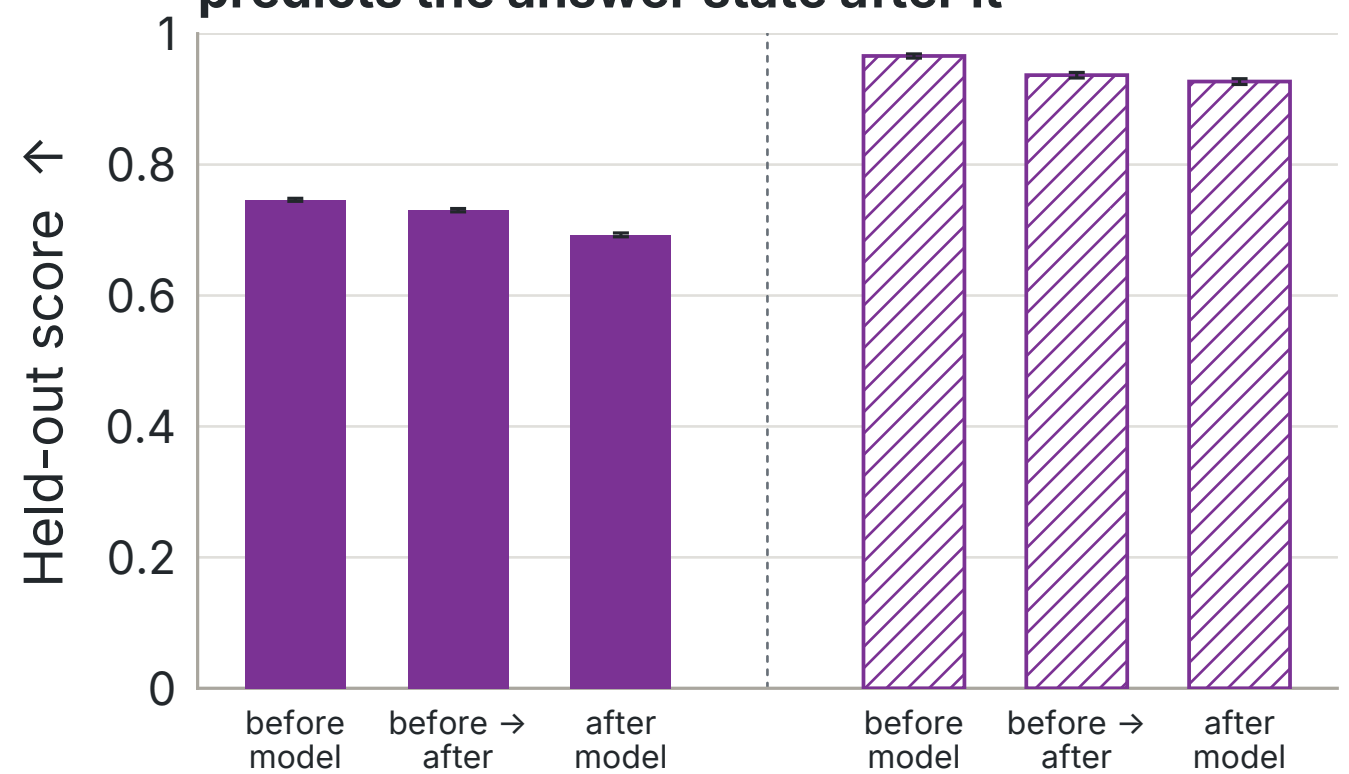
**Disabling thinking on the same weights  
leaves  $R^2$  unchanged**

Held-out  $R^2$ 

Answer retrieval (acc@1)

D · QWEN2.5-7B-INSTRUCT (BEFORE) → OPENTHINKER3-7B (AFTER), LAYER 19

**The context state before reasoning training  
predicts the answer state after it**

Held-out  $R^2$ 

Answer retrieval (acc@1)